

The Current Persecution of Christians in China

Aug. 8, 2026

I would like to share what I heard **directly this morning from members of our Bible study**. Most of the participants are members of a church in China that has been the target of government persecution. Their families and fellow believers are directly affected by the arrests, investigations, and trials taking place there.

Last year, several pastors and elders were detained by Chinese authorities. One senior church leader was recently released following diplomatic developments surrounding President Trump's visit to China, but several others remain detained and are awaiting trial.

Eight church members are expected to face sentencing between the 10th and 12th of this month.

According to what we heard, their lawyers were given very limited time to prepare their defense, and normal procedural time was not observed.

The authorities are pursuing two major charges:

- **Financial misconduct / alleged bribery:** Authorities have pressured people who voluntarily donated money toward the detained leaders' legal expenses to sign statements claiming they had been deceived into donating. Some donors refused and confirmed that their giving was entirely voluntary.
- **Operating an illegal school:** The church's Bible training school has been deemed illegal because institutions of this kind cannot legally be registered in China.

Even small donations have become a target of intimidation. One person connected to our Bible study donated less than RMB 100 toward legal expenses. She was summoned by the police, threatened, instructed to stop donating, and told to leave church WeChat groups.

There are also heartbreaking situations involving families. One detained elder's 97-year-old father, who is reportedly near the end of his life, asked to see his son one last time. Authorities reportedly denied even a brief supervised visit.

Another church member in Sichuan was previously sentenced to nine years in prison and has already served approximately eight years.

These are not simply reports we heard from the news. **They were shared with us this morning by people who have direct knowledge of the situation and whose own church community is being affected.**

I am sharing this not to provoke political debate, but to make others aware of what our brothers and sisters in China are experiencing.

Please remember them before the Lord and pray for them. If you know other believers who would be willing to learn about their situation, please share this with them and invite them to join us in prayer.

May God strengthen His church in China and help His people remain faithful to Christ in the midst of persecution.